



Tempe High School

YEARLY EXAMINATION

Year 8 English

General Instructions

- Reading time – 5 minutes
- Working time – 40 Minutes
- Write using black pen

Total Marks:
40

Section I – 10 marks (pages 3-6)

- Attempt Questions 1-4
- Allow about 20 minutes for this section

Section II – 5 marks (page 7-8)

- Attempt Question 5
- Allow about 20 minutes for this section

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Section I — Short Answer Questions

15 marks

Attempt Questions 1-9

Allow about 20 minutes for this section

Read the texts on pages 2–6 of carefully and then answer the questions in the spaces provided. These spaces provide guidance for the expected length of response.

Your answers will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate understanding of the ideas expressed in the texts
 - explain the answers using knowledge gained from the texts
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Text 1 – An extract from the play *Of Mice and Men*

A sandy bank on the river with a large sycamore tree. The stage is covered with dry leaves and lit by a setting sun. Curtain rises on an empty stage. A sparrow is singing. There is a distant sound of ranch dogs barking.

Two figures are seen entering the stage in single file, with George, the short man, coming in ahead of Lennie. Both men are carrying blanket rolls. They approach the river. The small man throws down his blanket roll, the large man follows, then falls down and drinks from the river, snorting as he drinks.

GEORGE: Lennie, for God's sake, don't drink so much!

Leans over and shakes Lennie.

Lennie, you hear me! You gonna be sick like you was last night.

LENNIE: *dips his whole head under, hat and all. As he sits upon the bank, his hat drips down the back.*

That's good. You drink some George. You drink some too.

GEORGE: *kneeling and dipping his finger in the water:*

I ain't sure it's good water. Looks kinda scummy to me

LENNIE: *imitates, dipping his finger also*

Look at them wrinkles in the water George, look what I done.

GEORGE: *drinking from his cupped palm*

Tastes all right. Don't seem to be runnin' much though, Lennie, you shouldn't drink water when it ain't running.

Hopelessly: You'd drink water out of a gutter if you was thirsty.

He throws a scoop of water into his face and rubs it around with his hand, pushes himself back and embraces his knees.

Lennie, after watching him, imitates him in every detail.

Answer Questions 1 & 2 using the Text 1

Question 1 (2 marks)

What type of atmosphere does the setting information at the beginning of the play create?

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Question 2 (3 marks)

What does George's dialogue and actions reveal about his character?

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Text 2 – Poem ‘The Past’ by Oodgeroo Noonuccal

Let no one say the past is dead.
The past is all about us and within.
Haunted by tribal memories, I know
This little now, this accidental present
Is not the all of me, whose long making
Is so much of the past.

Tonight here in suburbia as I sit
In easy chair before electric heater,
Warmed by the red glow, I fall into dream:
I am away
At the camp fire in the bush, among
My own people, sitting on the ground,
No walls about me,
The stars over me,
The tall surrounding trees that stir in the wind
Making their own music,
Soft cries of the night coming to us, there
Where we are one with all old Nature's lives
Known and unknown,
In scenes where we belong but have now forsaken.
Deep chair and electric radiator
Are but since yesterday,
But a thousand thousand camp fires in the forest
Are in my blood.
Let none tell me the past is wholly gone.
Now is so small a part of time, so small a part
Of all the race years that have moulded me.

Answer Questions 3 & 4 using the Text 2

Question 3 (2 marks)

How is imagery used in this poem to create a sense of connection?

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Question 4 (3 marks)

What does the poet suggest about ‘the past’ and our connection to it?

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Section II — Extended Writing

Allow about 20 minutes for this section

Your answers will be assessed on how well you:

- express your own opinion about the question asked
 - explain your answer
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Question 5 (5 marks)

The English faculty is interested in teaching a new topic or unit of work to Year 8 students next year.

What do you think is a contemporary issue or new text we should teach students in Year 8?

In your answer justify why this is important for students to know about and what would be the benefits of teaching it to our students.

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End of Exam